

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 776

By Lynn

A RESOLUTION to commend Green Hill Church on the occasion of its 125th anniversary.

WHEREAS, the churches of our nation have been an integral part of our history as a people and have had an unparalleled impact in forming and maintaining a stable and just society; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we should recognize those venerable religious institutions and their congregations who, through their unflagging capacity for love, dedication of spirit, and faith in God, strive to enrich the lives of people in their communities; and

WHEREAS, one such dynamic community of faith is that of Green Hill Church in Mt. Juliet, whose members will celebrate the church's 125th anniversary this year; and

WHEREAS, Green Hill Church traces its inception to September 22, 1900, when seventeen individuals congregated as the first members of what was then called Green Hill Baptist Church; the organization of the church came fifteen years after members began a nondenominational Sunday School that met in a one-room schoolhouse in the Green Hill community that included eight members of Little Cedar Lick Church; and

WHEREAS, the initial meeting was at Brother J.C. Lanius's home and opened with the song "Come Thou Fount of Every Blessing"; in addition to Little Cedar Lick Church, the twelve charter members also came from congregations in Mt. Olivet and Shop Springs; and

WHEREAS, the church continued to meet in the schoolhouse without a pastor until 1903, when the first church building was constructed on land donated by the Lanius family and through the efforts and largesse of various community members; and

WHEREAS, by 1961, the church began to see substantial growth, and on April 26, 1964, congregants voted to buy approximately ten acres of land for the location of new facilities; the

first unit of the church's current facilities had a groundbreaking ceremony on November 21, 1965; and

WHEREAS, expansion took place once more in 1976, with education and fellowship space constructed, and in 1980, with the acquisition of fifteen additional acres; the present-day sanctuary was completed and first occupied on Easter Sunday, March 31, 1991, with an estimated 868 individuals attending worship services and 535 in Sunday School; and

WHEREAS, the past decade of ministry at Green Hill Church has been marked by both internal impact and increased health within the congregation and external impact in the surrounding community; and

WHEREAS, in 2016, the church launched a partnership with nearby W.A. Wright Elementary School, and in March 2018, Pastor Daryl Crouch began the Everyone's Wilson initiative to facilitate partnerships among churches, businesses, and schools within Wilson County as Green Hill Church committed to pursuing the welfare of the community; and

WHEREAS, in 2019 and 2020, the Hospitality Project allowed the church to make renovations and help create welcoming spaces where Gospel growth could occur and respond to opportunities to expand its missional imprint; and

WHEREAS, in the fall of 2019, Green Hill Church partnered with Glenwood Baptist Church in an effort to revitalize their congregation in Nashville; at the same time, Pastor Derrick DeLain, along with approximately fifty other members of The Summit Church in North Carolina, began preparing to move to Nashville to plant Proclamation Church, ultimately incorporating members of Glenwood Baptist, with Green Hill Church continuing to offer support; and

WHEREAS, in October 2022, Green Hill Church committed to a vision to raise funds to renovate the house on the corner of the church's property along Lebanon Road to serve as a ministry house, positioning the church to expand its ministry in the coming years, reach more people with the Gospel, and raise future ministry leaders for the church; and

WHEREAS, the church launched the Generations campaign this year, a thirty-two-month long generosity initiative designed to accelerate and expand Green Hill Church's mission and ministries, creating a transformative legacy for future generations; and

WHEREAS, as the church celebrates 125 years of service, it continues to be a light in the community, and the devout members of the congregation have faithfully striven to carry out God's work in the world; and

WHEREAS, Green Hill Church is truly one of the great religious institutions and catalysts for positive spiritual change in our State and nation, and the members of this exceptional congregation should be appropriately honored for their exemplary service to their fellow Christians and the good people of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we join in the celebration of the 125th anniversary of Green Hill Church, thank the good people of this congregation and their ministers for their notable service to their Lord and the State of Tennessee, and wish them much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.